

get home.

She arrived home before Ben and was sorting through the mail when she came across an official looking envelope from the Internal Revenue Service. Her stomach did such a flip that she thought she might throw up. She sank down in one of the dining room chairs. She just stared at the envelope for several minutes. She wasn't sure she even wanted to know what it said. She suspected that Ben hadn't filed their taxes properly or that they were being audited.

Finally, she put the envelope down and slid out of the chair to her knees. Resting her elbows on the chair seat, she closed her eyes and began to pray. "Dear God, I know I'm living in fear and dread over our finances. I ask you to forgive my attitude and give me the peace that You promised. I know I have not been following Your path or living by Your plan, but I commit myself to You and to my husband, whatever the circumstances are." She hugged Timmy, who was laughing as he crawled over her.

She stood up and, picking up the envelope, started to open it. *No*, she thought, *I'll wait and let Ben open it. We'll face whatever it is together.* She dropped the letter on the table and began to fix their dinner.

Ben came home a few minutes later and walked over to Naomi. "Hi, honey. How did your day go?" Ben asked cheerfully.

"My day went great," Naomi replied as she wiped her hands and hugged Ben.

Ben was shocked by her sudden display of affection. It had been several months since she had even kissed him voluntarily. Their physical relationship had deteriorated so much that Ben was afraid to show any affection, for fear she would reject him.

"Ben, I know I've been depressed and moody about our finances the last few months," Naomi confessed.

"Don't worry about it," Ben replied. "I've given you plenty of cause to be worried in the past. But I am committed to making a change. I want to be a good husband with God's help."